METHODOLOGY DOCUMENT
MSCI SUSTAINABILITY AND CLIMATE

March 2026

MSCI ESG Ratings Methodology: Supply Chain Labor Standards Key Issue

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Introduction

This document provides essential information on the components of the Supply Chain Labor Standards Key Issue to enable users of ESG Ratings to understand how MSCI Sustainability & Climate ("MSCI S&C")[1] outputs are determined. Supply Chain Labor Standards is a Key Issue in the Social Pillar of the MSCI ESG Ratings model. Companies are evaluated on the management and transparency of their supply chain and the working standards in the regions in which their suppliers are located.

For additional details on the MSCI ESG Ratings Model, refer to Section 2, Data, ratings and scores, of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Exhibit 1: MSCI ESG Key Issue hierarchy

3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
Environmental	Climate Change	Carbon Emissions
		Climate Change Vulnerability
		Financing Environmental Impact
		Product Carbon Footprint
	Natural Capital	Biodiversity & Land Use
		Raw Material Sourcing
		Water Stress
	Pollution & Waste	Electronic Waste
		Packaging Material & Waste
		Toxic Emissions & Waste
	Environmental Opportunities	Opportunities in Clean Tech
		Opportunities in Green Building
		Opportunities in Renewable Energy
Social	**Human Capital**	Health & Safety
		Human Capital Development
		Labor Management
		Supply Chain Labor Standards
	Product Liability	Chemical Safety
		Consumer Financial Protection
		Privacy & Data Security
		Product Safety & Quality
		Responsible Investment
	Stakeholder Opposition	Community Relations
		Controversial Sourcing
	Social Opportunities	Access to Finance
		Access to Health Care

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3 Pillars	10 Themes	33 ESG Key Issues
		Opportunities in Nutrition & Health
Governance	Corporate Governance	Board
		Pay
		Ownership & Control
		Accounting
	Corporate Behavior	Business Ethics
		Tax Transparency

Risks associated with this Key Issue

- Production delays due to labor unrest in supply chains.
- Reduced productivity and product quality.
- Loss of growth opportunities, market share or pricing power due to negative publicity and damage to brand value.

Supply Chain Labor Standards Key Issue score

The Supply Chain Labor Standards Key Issue score evaluates the company's level of exposure to, and management of, risks on this Key Issue. The Key Issue score is based on the Exposure score and the Management score using the formula below. The Exposure score and the Management score are combined such that a higher level of exposure requires a higher level of demonstrated management capability in order to achieve the same overall Key Issue score.

$$KI_i = 7 - (\max(EXP_i, 2) - MGMT_i)$$

Where:

- KI_i is the Key Issue score for company i.
- EXP_i is the Exposure score for company i.
- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score for company i.

Supply Chain Labor Standards Management Framework

The table below outlines the indicators mapped to their respective components that inform the Supply Chain Labor Standards Management score, excluding controversies. MSCI S&C assigns each indicator a default weight. Indicator weights may be adjusted at the company level to reflect the relevance of the

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indicator to the company's business activities. If a company has no exposure to the business activities covered by an indicator, the indicator is assigned a weight of zero.

Component	Sustainability Indicator
Supply Chain Labor Standards Practices score	Scope of supplier code of conduct
	Trains suppliers on labor issues
	Supplier selection based on labor management performance
	Evidence of supplier audits
	Action taken to address supplier misconduct
	Extent of disclosure on instances of supplier misconduct
	Scope of supplier audits
	Effectiveness of grievance mechanisms
	Commitment to pay living wage for workers in supply chains

Supply Chain Labor Standards Management score

The Supply Chain Labor Standards Management score evaluates the company's ability to manage its exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on weighted average of score associated with each relevant indicator, modified by controversies.

This score is derived from indicators that are scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to best practice. Refer to Section 3.3, Analyzing risk management, of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. Sources are company disclosures except where otherwise indicated.

The following formula is used to calculate the Supply Chain Labor Standards Management score - Excluding Controversies:

$$MGMT_i = \sum Indicator_Score_{j,i} * Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $MGMT_i$ is the Management score - Excluding Controversies for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.

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- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.

The following formula is used to calculate the scores for the components

$$COMP_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Score_{j,i} \ * \ Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_{c,i}$ is the component score for component c, for company i.
- $Indicator_Score_{j,i}$ is the score of indicator j for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_Scaled_{j,i}$ is the scaled weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The following formula is used to calculate the weights for the components

$$COMP_Weight_{c,i} = \sum_{j \in c} Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$$

Where:

- $COMP_Weight_{c,i}$ is the component weight for component c for company i.
- $Indicator_Weight_{j,i}$ is the weight of indicator j for company i.
- $j \in c$ indicates that the summation is over all indicators belonging to component c.

The definitions of the data points in each component are given below:

Supply Chain Labor Standards Practices score

Assesses the company's ability to manage its exposure to risks related to the management and transparency of its supply chain. This score is equal to the Supply Chain Labor Standards Management score (excluding controversies) and considers attributes of the company's policies and initiatives. Expressed as a 0–10 score, where 10 indicates strong initiatives.

- **Scope of supplier code of conduct**

Definition: Assesses inclusion of key labor standards in supplier code of conduct such as wages, working hours and worker protections. Expressed as a 0-10 score, with 10 indicating strong initiatives.

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- **Supply chain code of conduct covers anti-discrimination**

Definition: Indicates whether the company's supply chain code of conduct sets forth requirements forbidding suppliers from engaging in discrimination regarding their employees.

- **Supply chain code of conduct covers child labor**

Definition: Indicates whether the company's supply chain code of conduct forbids suppliers to use underage labor.

- **Supply chain code of conduct covers forced labor**

Definition: Indicates whether the company's supply chain code of conduct forbids suppliers to use forced labor.

- **Supply chain code of conduct covers freedom of association**

Definition: Indicates whether the company's supply chain code of conduct sets forth requirements that suppliers respect freedom of association and allow workers to unionize if desired.

- **Supply chain code of conduct covers health and safety**

Definition: Indicates whether the company's supply chain code of conduct sets forth requirements regarding health and safety working conditions at supplier factories.

- **Supply chain code of conduct covers minimum wage**

Definition: Indicates whether the company's supply chain code of conduct sets forth requirements regarding the minimum wages that suppliers must pay their employees.

- **Supply chain code of conduct covers paid overtime**

Definition: Indicates whether the company's supply chain code of conduct sets forth requirements that suppliers pay overtime wages when employees must work overtime hours.

- **Supply chain code of conduct covers working hours**

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Definition: Indicates whether the company's supply chain code of conduct sets forth requirements limiting the amount of hours suppliers' employees may be required to work in a day or a week.

- **Trains suppliers on labor related social issues**

Definition: Indicates whether the company has specific training programs in place with its suppliers on its supplier code of conduct or specific labor-related issues.

- **Supplier selection based on labor management performance**

Definition: Indicates whether the company considers suppliers' performance in allocating or renewing contracts, and/or placing further orders.

- **Evidence of supplier audits**

Definition: Indicates whether the company conducts internal and/or external audits across its supply chain.

- **Action taken to address supplier misconduct**

Definition: Indicates whether the company provides evidence of developing a remediation action plan when incidents of noncompliance with its code of conduct are found.

- **Extent of disclosure on instances of supplier misconduct**

Definition: Indicates whether the company discloses the frequency and type of noncompliance incidents found in its supply chain.

- **Scope of supplier audits**

Definition: Assesses the extent of audits conducted across the company's supply chains. Expressed as a 0-10 score, with 10 indicating strong initiatives.

  - **Tier 1 supplier audits (direct suppliers)**

    Definition: Indicates whether some or all Tier 1 suppliers (i.e., direct suppliers) are covered by the social audit program of the company.

  - **Tier 2 suppliers audits (components)**

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Definition: Indicates whether some or all Tier 2 suppliers (i.e., components) are covered by the social audit program of the company.

- **Tier 3 suppliers audits (raw materials)**

Definition: Indicates whether some or all Tier 3 suppliers (i.e., raw materials) are covered by the social audit program of the company.

- **Effectiveness of grievance mechanisms**

Definition: Assesses the effectiveness of grievance mechanisms for supply chain workers.

- **Commitment to pay living wage for workers in supply chains**

Definition: Assesses the company's commitment to pay a living wage to its supply chain workers.

Sources: company disclosures, International Labour Organization.

Controversies

A controversy deduction ranging from 0 to 5 points is subtracted from the overall Management score based on the severity, status, and the company's role in the controversies facing the company on this Key Issue. The following categories of controversies are used in the assessment:

- Supply chain labor standards controversies.

For more details on how controversies are included in the MSCI ESG Ratings model, refer to Section 3.3.2, Controversies cases, of "ESG Ratings Methodology."

Supply Chain Labor Standards Exposure score

The Supply Chain Labor Standards Exposure score evaluates the company's exposure to risks on this Key Issue. It is based on the Business and Company-Specific Exposure Scores. The Business Exposure score and Company-Specific Exposure score is scored on a 0-10 scale, with 10 corresponding to the highest risk and 0 corresponding to the lowest risk. Refer to Section 3.2, Analyzing risk exposure, of "ESG Ratings Methodology" for additional details. The following data sources and methodologies are used in the Exposure score calculation:

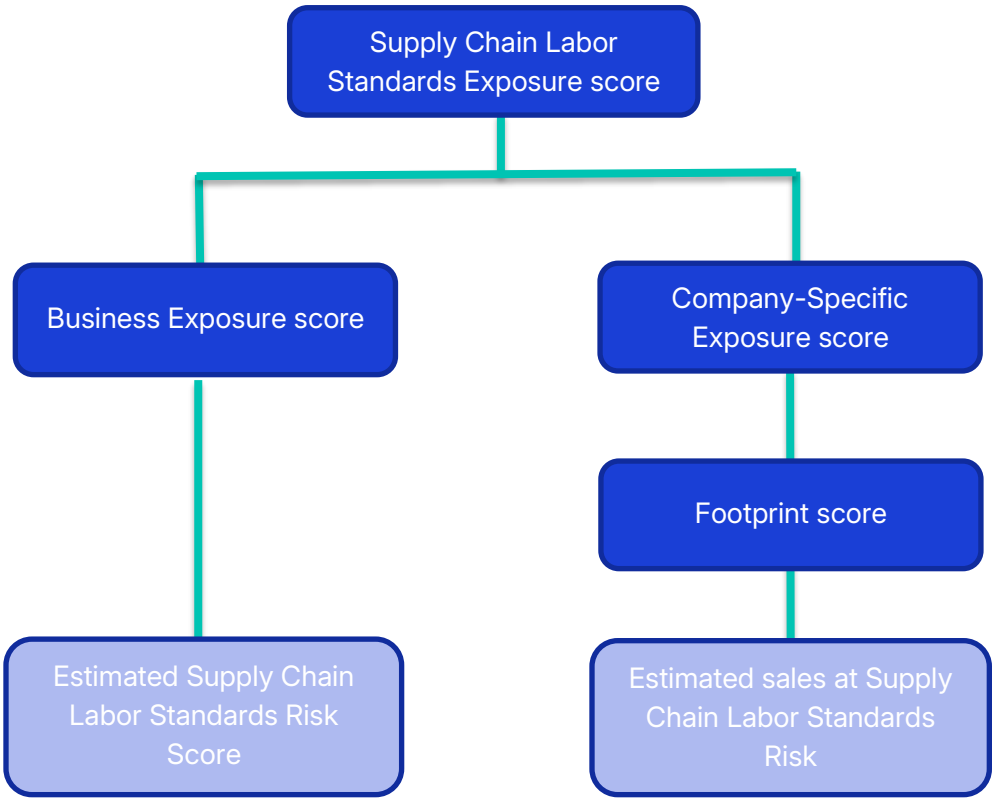
$$EXP_{SLS,i} = \frac{BUS_{SLS,i} + COM_{SLS,i}}{2}$$

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Where:

- $EXP_{SLS,i}$ is the Supply Chain Labor Standards Exposure score of company i.
- $BUS_{SLS,i}$ is the Business Exposure score of company i.
- $COM_{SLS,i}$ is the Company-Specific Exposure score of company i.

Exhibit 2: Exposure score components



Company-Specific Exposure score

The Company-Specific Exposure score is determined using the formula below:

$$COM_{SLS,i} = FS_{SLS,i}$$

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Where:

- $FS_{SLS,i}$ is the Footprint score of company i.

Footprint score is derived as:

$$FS_{SLS,i} = Scale_{0-10}\{WASR_{SLS,i} \times 3\ yr\ avgerage\ sales\ _{SLS,i} \times Private\ label\ \%_{SLS,i}\}$$

Where:

- $WASR_{SLS,i}$ is the weighted average Supply Chain Labor Standards risk percentage of company i.
- $3\ yr\ average\ sales\ _{SLS,i}$ is the 3-year sales average of company i.
- $Private\ label\ \%_{SLS,i}$ is the private label percentage where applicable[2] of company i.

Weighted average Supply Chain Labor Standards risk percentage of company is derived as:

$$WASR_{SLS,i} = \sum_{k=1}^{n_i} w_{Revenue,i,k} ERP_{SLS,k}$$

Where:

- $ERP_{SLS,k}$ is the Estimated Supply Chain Labor Standards Risk Percentage for the business segment k.
- $w_{Revenue,i,j}$ is the weight of business segment k for company i based on the contribution to total company revenue.
- n_i is the number of business segments of company i.

Estimated Supply Chain Labor Standards Risk Percentage indicates the estimated percentage of a product or business activity's supply chain derived from markets with child or forced labor risk. It is calculated using three data sources: The U.S. Department of Labor's list of goods produced by child labor or forced labor identifies high-risk commodities and their countries of origin; The United Nations Comtrade database global trade data identifies the flow of goods between countries and quantifies the at-risk proportion of global exports for each commodity; The U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis Input-Output Use Table map supply chain dependencies by tracing the flow of inputs across industries.

These sources are integrated to estimate the percentage of input linked to child or forced labor risk for a product or business activity.

[2] Private Label Percentage applies to companies that derive revenue from retail business operations or operate under a retail business model.

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Business Exposure score

The Business Exposure score is determined using the formula below.

$$BUS_{SLS,i} = \sum_{k=1}^{n_i} w_{Revenue,i,k} BSE_{SLS,k}$$

Where:

- $BUS_{SLS,i}$ is the Business Exposure score of company i.
- $BSE_{SLS,k}$ is the Business Segment Exposure score of company i.
- $w_{Revenue,i,j}$ is the weight of business segment k of company i based on the contribution to total company revenue.
- n_i is the number of business segments of company i.

Business Segment Exposure score

The Business Segment Exposure score of a business segment is based on a mapping of the business segment as disclosed by the company to a corresponding business activity. MSCI S&C uses the Standard Industrial Classification (SIC) system along with industry-specific adjustments to define business activities.

The Business Segment Exposure score is the Estimated Supply Chain Labor Standards Risk score for the business segment k. It is derived from converting Estimated Supply Chain Labor Standards Risk Percentage to a 0 to 10 score.

Data sources

The following sources are used to determine the Supply Chain Labor Standards Exposure score:

United Nations. "Trade Flow" UN Comtrade Database; U.S. Department of Labor, "List of Goods Produced by Child Labor or Forced Labor;" U.S. Bureau of Economic Analysis, "2017 Input-Output Use Table (use of commodities by industry);" U.S. Census Bureau, 2017 Economic Census - NAPCS Product Lines Statistics (Table ID: ECNNAPCSIND2017.EC1700NAPCSINDPRD); Industry by Products for the U.S. and States, 2017; MSCI S&C; company disclosures.

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Canada	+ 1 416 687 6270
Brazil	+ 55 11 4040 7830
Mexico	+ 52 81 1253 4020

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South Africa	+ 27 21 673 0103
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